

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

ENERG0.18

COMM.0.36

CONS.0.48

HEALT0.51

UTILI0.81

REAL0.98

TECHN1.31

CONS.1.63

MATER1.67

FINAN2.49

INDUS2.57

1

AMZN

BUY

\$247.36

-1.05%

8/10

Amazon is a three-headed monster (retail, AWS, ads) with a stealth AI

2

NVDA

BUY

\$205.09

+0.89%

8/10

The world's AI infrastructure backbone, benefiting from massive hypers

3

GOOGL

BUY

\$348.88

-0.88%

8/10

Dominant search + cloud + AI infrastructure play with OpenAI stumbling

Big options bets on MSFT (Technology) — 26.9x normal volume, P/C 0.18, largest: PUT \$415 (19.6x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

No major earnings this week

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

Consumer Confidence

Date: 2026-07-24

MEDIUM

VIX at 17.7 — low. Options market complacent ahead of scheduled events.

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Big money is aggressively loading up on Energy, Communication Services, Consumer Discretionary, and Healthcare — the Energy bid is particularly loud and lines up with the administration's "drill baby drill" posture, looser permitting, and the geopolitical premium from ongoing Middle East and Russia sanctions chess, while the Comm Services and Discretionary buying suggests smart money thinks the consumer isn't rolling over yet and that the AI ad-spend cycle at Meta and Google still has legs.

The Healthcare bullishness is the sneaky one — it's likely a bet that the worst of the drug pricing and tariff rhetoric is priced in, and that any softening of Most-Favored-Nation pricing threats becomes a relief rally.

On the exit side, the bearish flow in Financials, Industrials, and Materials is a giant red flag: those are the classic "real economy" sectors, and when combined with widening credit spreads and heavy hedging in investment-grade bonds (LQD), it screams that institutions are quietly bracing for tariff blowback, slower capex, and margin pressure from a manufacturing slowdown that the tariff regime is starting to bite into.

The Tech bearishness is the contradiction worth staring at — the Nasdaq keeps making highs but the options market is betting big on a pullback, which usually means hedge funds are protecting gains rather than calling a crash, especially with antitrust cases and the AI capex-vs-revenue debate looming.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	GTLB	GitLab Inc.	8.16/100
GitLab's DevSecOps platform is being repositioned as an AI-native			
2.	DDOG	Datadog, Inc.	7.93/100
Datadog is a direct beneficiary of AI workload observability as e			
3.	MSFT	Microsoft Corporation	7.71/100
Microsoft remains the best-in-class large-cap AI monetization sto			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 19–20	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy **\$326.96 ▲ 0.11%** 12M Price Target **\$360.00** 52-Week Range **\$201.50 – \$334.99**

Market Cap
\$4.80T

AAPL: Alibaba Deal Unlocks China AI, But Tariffs Loom

WHAT HAPPENED

- Apple's tie-up with Alibaba is getting fresh attention — it's the plumbing that lets Apple Intelligence (their AI features) actually work in China, which is a market they've been quietly losing. This is why the stock ripped to \$333 last week and is now consolidating around \$327.
- Chip stocks (Intel, AMD, Broadcom) are ripping today on RBC's bullish call — that's dragging the whole tech sector up +1.76%, but AAPL is only up 0.11%, meaning it's lagging. That tells you the easy money from the Alibaba news is already in the price.

WHY IT MATTERS

AAPL is sitting at 94% of its 52-week range, which means most of the good news is baked in and the stock needs a fresh catalyst to break out. The unusual call buying at \$325-\$327.50 strikes expiring this week tells me traders are betting on a small pop, not a moonshot — they're playing for a nickel, not a dollar. The bigger picture: Apple's growth story has shifted from iPhone units to services + AI monetization, and the Alibaba deal is the missing puzzle piece for China. But here's the tension — the more Apple leans on China for AI compute, the more exposed they are if Washington escalates tech restrictions, which is a real risk under the current tariff-heavy trade posture.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to watch: (1) Section 301 China tariff reviews — Apple assembles ~85% of iPhones in China, so any tariff escalation hits margins directly, and the administration has been signaling more pressure on semiconductor and consumer electronics supply chains. (2) The DOJ antitrust case against Apple's App Store is still grinding forward — a bad ruling could force them to open up payments (losing that juicy 30% cut on in-app purchases, which is basically pure profit). The EU's Digital Markets Act is already forcing changes; if the US follows, services revenue growth slows meaningfully.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

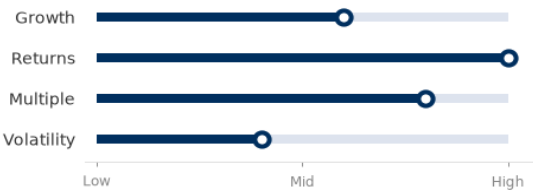
At ~44x forward earnings (paying \$44 for every \$1 of profit next year), AAPL is trading at a premium to its own history (usually 25-30x) and richer than Google or Meta. That premium only makes sense if you believe the AI + services story delivers double-digit growth — and right now revenue is only growing ~5-7%. In plain English: you're paying a Ferrari price for a car that's still driving at Toyota speed, betting the engine upgrade (AI) kicks in soon.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$326.96
12M Price Target	\$360.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.1%
Market Cap	\$4.80T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.45
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	43.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$345.00	\$330.00	\$310.00
6 Months	\$370.00	\$345.00	\$295.00
1 Year	\$400.00	\$360.00	\$280.00
2 Years	\$460.00	\$400.00	\$270.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$480.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors are on fire today (Intel +6%, AMD +4%, Broadcom +3%) on RBC's Q2 beat call — AI capex is still very much alive, and that's a tailwind for Apple's silicon partners.

COOLING OFF: Tech is actually -2.63% over 5 days despite today's bounce — investors got jittery ahead of mega-cap earnings and are trimming after a huge run.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating within tech — out of software, into chips and AI infrastructure. That's a mixed signal for AAPL: they benefit from AI enthusiasm but they're not a pure-play AI name, so they get less of the flow.

RELATED PLAY: If you like AAPL's China AI angle, Broadcom (AVGO) and TSMC (TSM) are the picks-and-shovels — they make the silicon that powers all of it, and they're less exposed to consumer demand cycles.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- INTC (Intel): +6% on RBC upgrade — the Q2 beat call has people believing the turnaround is real, plus CHIPS Act money is still flowing.
- AMD (Advanced Micro Devices): +4% — riding the AI chip demand wave, seen as the credible #2 to Nvidia in data center GPUs.

AAPL CONTEXT: AAPL is lagging its tech peers today (+0.11% vs Tech ETF +1.76%) — that's a yellow flag. It means the Alibaba pop is done and the stock needs a new catalyst (likely Q3 earnings) to move. Not bearish, just tells you not to chase here.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — high-quality business at a full price; I like it but I'm not pounding the table at these levels.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% of portfolio — this is a core holding, not a trade. You want size because the buyback + dividend + moat combo compounds, but not more because the valuation is stretched.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$310-320 (roughly 5% below current) — those dips have been buyable all year. Chasing at \$333 has been a losing trade twice now.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is either the next iPhone cycle showing AI-driven upgrades OR clarity on the DOJ case.

WHEN TO BAIL: If China revenue drops more than 15% year-over-year, or if the DOJ wins a structural remedy (like forcing App Store changes), the thesis is broken — sell.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy put options (insurance that pays out if the stock drops) around earnings dates when volatility is cheap. Or just trim 20% of your position if it runs above \$340 and rebuild on dips.

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$134.47 ▼ 0.29%	12M Price Target \$155.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$322.35B
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PLTR: Coiling Before Aug 3 Earnings, AI Tailwinds Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- Quiet tape today — stock basically flat on tiny volume (6.3M vs ~30M normal), which usually means traders are sitting on their hands waiting for the Aug 3 earnings print. The Motley Fool "parabolic after Aug 3" article is stoking retail excitement, but the pros are just watching.
- Director Alexander Moore dumped ~\$2.1M last week around \$134 — that's not a "the sky is falling" sale, but it's the second insider sell cluster this quarter and worth noting when you're paying a nosebleed multiple.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what the setup is telling me: PLTR is coiled tight in a \$132-135 range, way off its 52-week high of \$207, and options traders are leaning bullish (put/call ratio of 0.62 means way more call bets than put bets — people are positioning for upside). That combo — beaten-down price + bullish options + earnings in 13 days — usually means the market is expecting a strong print to break the stock out. The "regulated AI" angle from Simply Wall St matters more than people realize: Palantir's FedRAMP High and IL6 certifications are effectively a moat because every new federal AI rule makes it harder for competitors to catch up. But at a \$322B market cap on ~\$4B of revenue, this stock needs to keep delivering 30%+ growth AND beat guidance, or it gets punished hard.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

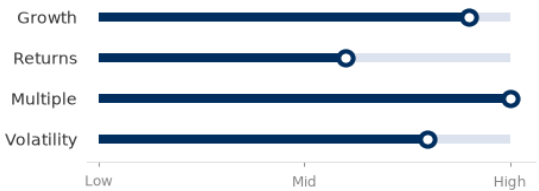
The big one to watch: the FY2027 defense authorization discussions and the ongoing federal AI procurement push under the current administration — Palantir is one of the biggest beneficiaries of the Pentagon's "software-first" acquisition reforms. Also on the radar: any executive action on AI export controls to China, which cuts both ways (limits Palantir's international TAM but crushes Chinese competitors and forces allied governments deeper into US-approved vendors like PLTR). If Congress advances any version of a federal AI safety/compliance framework this fall, PLTR is the most obvious winner because they're already built for that regulatory environment — smaller AI shops would have to spend years and millions catching up.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$134.47
12M Price Target	\$155.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.3%
Market Cap	\$322.35B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,250M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,600M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.58
FY2027E EPS	\$0.82
Fwd P/E	231.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$160.00	\$140.00	\$118.00
6 Months	\$185.00	\$150.00	\$110.00
1 Year	\$210.00	\$155.00	\$95.00
2 Years	\$260.00	\$175.00	\$85.00
5 Years	\$400.00	\$220.00	\$70.00
10 Years	\$650.00	\$300.00	\$50.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech +1.76% today led by AI infrastructure names — the administration's continued push on federal AI adoption and reshoring of critical tech is a direct tailwind. Energy also perking up (+1.98% on 5-day) on power demand for AI data centers.

COOLING OFF: Tech is actually down 2.63% over 5 days despite today's bounce — some profit-taking after a hot run, and rate-cut expectations getting recalibrated.

ROTATION WATCH: Money looks like it's rotating within tech from expensive software into AI-picks-and-shovels (chips, power, data centers). PLTR sits awkwardly in the middle — it's software but with an AI + defense story, which is why it's holding up better than pure SaaS names.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the federal AI spending thesis, look at the picks-and-shovels — data center REITs (DLR, EQIX), and defense-tech peers like Booz Allen (BAH) and Leidos (LDOS) who often partner with Palantir on federal work.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the default AI trade — every federal AI dollar eventually funds GPU purchases.
- ANET (Arista Networks): Networking gear for AI data centers, cleaner story with less multiple risk than PLTR.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is lagging its 52-week high by 35% while NVDA and other AI names have been making new highs — that tells me the market has been rerating PLTR's multiple lower even as the business grows. Either the stock catches up post-earnings, or the multiple compression continues. Aug 3 is the referee.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I love the business, but the valuation and earnings-event risk keep me from pounding the table right here.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — real upside, but the volatility (stock has traded from \$106 to \$207 in a year) means you need to size it so a 30% drawdown doesn't ruin your week.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd rather add on weakness — \$118-125 if we get pre-earnings jitters, or a post-print flush if guidance disappoints. Chasing here at \$134 into earnings is a coin flip.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst path: Aug 3 earnings → fall federal budget cycle → 2027 AI procurement guidance.

WHEN TO BAIL: If US government revenue growth drops below 30% YoY, or if they lose a marquee commercial customer, or if Karp signals commercial deal cycles are elongating — thesis breaks.

HEDGING: If you own it into earnings and want to sleep at night, buy a put option that expires in mid-August — think of it as insurance that pays out if the stock drops sharply. Costs a bit, but caps your downside through the event.

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy	\$247.36 ▼ 1.05%	12M Price Target \$295.00	52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$278.56	Market Cap \$2.66T
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AMZN: Trainium Chips Quietly Chipping Away at Nvidia

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN down about 1% on tiny volume (5.4M vs normal 40M+) — this is a sleepy summer Tuesday, not real selling. The Yahoo strategist piece calling for retiring the "Magnificent 7" label is actually bullish subtext: it means people are realizing these names aren't moving as one anymore, and AMZN's story (chips + ads + AWS) is diverging from Apple/Tesla.
- The Trainium chip story is the real news. Amazon's in-house AI chips are reportedly winning workloads from Nvidia into 2027 — if true, that's a massive margin story because AWS stops paying Nvidia's 70%+ gross margin tax.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what's actually going on: the tech sector was up 1.76% today but AMZN was down — that's a mini-divergence worth noting. It probably means money is flowing to Nvidia and pure-play AI hardware ahead of earnings season, while AMZN gets treated as a "boring" mega-cap. That's usually the setup right before AMZN catches up — the Trainium narrative is the catalyst that could force a re-rating. Watch AWS growth in the next earnings print: if it prints above 19%, the chip story becomes real to Wall Street, and this stock breaks \$260 fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two big things on the political radar: (1) The expanding Iran conflict is a wildcard — Big Tech cloud infrastructure is now considered critical national security, which could actually mean MORE government cloud contracts for AWS (tailwind), but also more cyber-target risk. (2) The de minimis tariff loophole closure (packages under \$800 from China getting hit with duties) is quietly helping Amazon's retail business because it kneecaps Temu and Shein — that's a real margin tailwind nobody's pricing in. Also watch the FTC antitrust case that's still grinding along; a settlement (not a breakup) is increasingly likely and would remove an overhang.

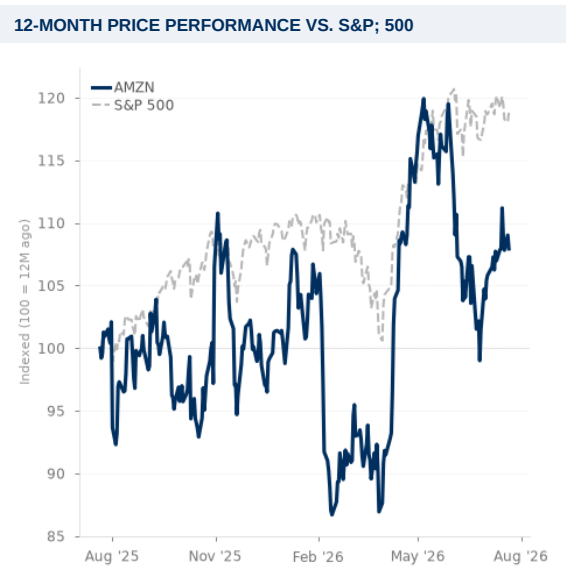
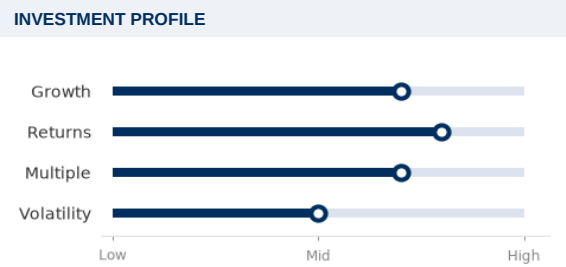
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$247, you're paying about 36x next year's earnings — meaning \$36 for every \$1 of profit expected. That sounds pricey, but AWS alone is probably worth \$1.5T if you spin it out at cloud peer multiples, which means you're basically getting the world's largest e-commerce business plus a \$60B ads business for "free." Compared to Microsoft at 32x with slower growth, AMZN's actually reasonable if you believe Trainium delivers.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- If the Iran situation escalates into oil supply disruption, consumer discretionary spending tanks and Amazon's retail arm takes a direct hit — Cons. Disc. ETF is already down 0.88% over 5 days, that's the early warning.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$247.36
12M Price Target	\$295.00
Upside / (Downside)	+19.3%
Market Cap	\$2.66T
FY2026E Revenue	\$715M
FY2027E Revenue	\$790M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	36.1x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$265.00	\$252.00	\$235.00
6 Months	\$290.00	\$270.00	\$225.00
1 Year	\$320.00	\$295.00	\$215.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$335.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$425.00	\$250.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.76% today) is bouncing on AI enthusiasm and the possibility that rate cuts return to the table. Energy (+1.98% over 5 days) is riding the Iran premium.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-0.88% over 5 days) is warning about consumer health — this matters for AMZN's retail side. Industrials also soft, suggesting economic slowdown fears.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing from broad Mag 7 into specific AI winners (Nvidia, hyperscalers with chip stories). AMZN sits in both camps — that's why it's not moving with either.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the Trainium story, the second-order winners are TSMC (they fab the chips) and the data center power names like Vistra and Constellation Energy — AI needs electricity and AMZN is a massive buyer.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI trade of record, sucking up flows ahead of earnings — ironic given the Trainium threat story.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Ad market recovery + their own TPU chip narrative mirrors what AMZN is doing with Trainium.

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is lagging its mega-cap tech peers this week, which is exactly the setup value-conscious buyers look for. Options flow tells the real story — heavy bullish call buying at \$185-195 strikes (way below current price, so these are likely rolled/hedge positions) alongside a bullish 0.80 put/call ratio suggests smart money is positioned long. When AMZN lags then catches up, moves tend to be sharp.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Not pounding the table, but this is one of the cleanest risk/reward setups in mega-cap tech right now given the chip optionality.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a 20% drawdown doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: Current levels (\$247) are fine to start; add aggressively on any pullback to \$235-240 which lines up with the 200-day average.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalysts are Q3 earnings (AWS growth number), any Trainium customer wins, and antitrust resolution.

WHEN TO BAIL: If AWS growth decelerates two quarters in a row, or if the FTC pushes for structural breakup rather than settlement — those change the thesis materially.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is buying put options 10% below current price expiring in 6 months — think of it as insurance that pays off if the stock crashes. Costs you maybe 2-3% of your position value but lets you sleep during Iran headlines.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$128.19 ▲ 6.95%	12M Price Target \$145.00	52-Week Range \$119.68 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.69T
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SPCX: Space ETF Bounces After Brutal Selloff, SpaceX Earnings Loom

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX bounced 7% today after a brutal week (down from \$135 to \$120 in four sessions). This is a classic oversold bounce — the stock hit the bottom 8% of its 52-week range and buyers stepped in. Volume was actually LOWER than the down days, which tells me this is a technical rebound, not conviction buying.
- The big catalyst on everyone's radar: SpaceX reports its first-ever earnings on Aug 4. SpaceX is the gorilla in this ETF, and the stock reportedly fell below its IPO price — Motley Fool is calling it a contrarian buy, which is why sentiment is shifting.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what's really going on: SPCX isn't really trading on its own fundamentals right now — it's a proxy for SpaceX sentiment ahead of Aug 4 earnings. The put/call ratio and unusual put activity at \$90 and \$123 strikes tells me smart money is hedging for a nasty earnings miss, not betting on a rip higher. That said, the fact that SpaceX is pitching itself to power Pentagon AI (competing with Microsoft, Amazon, Google) is a huge signal — if they land even a piece of that contract, it re-rates the entire space sector. The 8% of 52-week range positioning means risk/reward is finally getting interesting, but you're basically buying a lottery ticket on Aug 4.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big political tailwind: the FY2027 NASA and DoD budgets are being negotiated right now, and the administration has signaled continued Golden Dome missile defense investment — that's a direct pipeline to space companies. Watch the Pentagon's JWCC (Joint Warfighting Cloud Capability) expansion — if SpaceX gets added as a fifth vendor alongside Microsoft, Amazon, Google, and Oracle, it's a game-changer for Starlink/Starshield revenue. Headwind to watch: the FCC spectrum allocation fights and any ITAR export restrictions on satellite tech to allies could pinch international revenue for the ETF's holdings.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

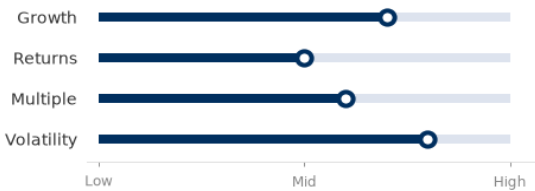
Quick reality check on the data — the \$1.69T market cap listed is clearly a data error (SPCX is a small ETF with roughly \$80-100M in AUM). The ETF itself trades at whatever its underlying holdings trade at, so valuation here really means: are Rocket Lab, Iridium, Planet Labs, and the private SpaceX allocation collectively cheap? After a 43% drawdown from the \$225 high, you're paying a lot less for the same growth story — but "cheap" only matters if SpaceX earnings don't blow up the thesis on Aug 4.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

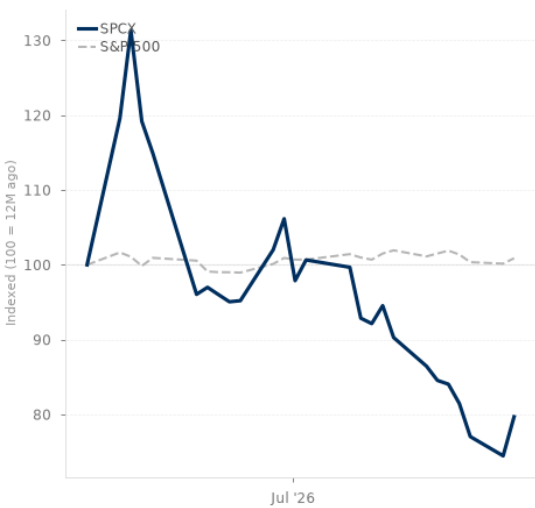
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$128.19
12M Price Target	\$145.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.1%
Market Cap	\$1.69T
FY2026E Revenue	—
FY2027E Revenue	—
FY2026E EPS	N/M
FY2027E EPS	N/M
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$145.00	\$132.00	\$115.00
6 Months	\$170.00	\$145.00	\$110.00
1 Year	\$200.00	\$155.00	\$100.00
2 Years	\$240.00	\$180.00	\$95.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$240.00	\$120.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$320.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+1.76%) is leading again as AI names find their footing — and Pentagon AI contract news is bleeding positive sentiment into space/defense adjacencies. Energy is quietly strong (+1.98% over 5 days) on Middle East risk premium.

COOLING OFF: Tech is still down 2.63% over 5 days — the recent selloff hit high-beta growth names hardest, which is exactly where SPCX lives. Consumer Discretionary and Industrials both negative on the week.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from mega-cap AI into defensive plays and now sniffing around beaten-down growth. Space ETF bouncing today fits that "hunt for oversold quality growth" pattern.

RELATED PLAY: If you want the space theme without SpaceX earnings risk, look at ITA (defense ETF) or pure-plays like RKLB (Rocket Lab) which has been outperforming on its own contract wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Winning share as SpaceX faces valuation reset — small-launch market is theirs to lose
- LUNR (Intuitive Machines): Lunar contracts from NASA CLPS program keep flowing regardless of SpaceX drama

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging pure-play space names because it's weighted toward SpaceX exposure — that's a double-edged sword. If SpaceX earnings surprise positively, SPCX outperforms peers. If not, individual names like RKLB will keep taking share.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Cautiously interested but not pounding the table with Aug 4 earnings looming as a binary event

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% max — the ETF concentration in one private company (SpaceX) makes this less diversified than it looks

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for either (a) the Aug 4 earnings dust to settle, or (b) another leg down to \$115-120 where risk/reward improves

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the real story is the 2027-2028 space economy inflection, not next quarter

WHEN TO BAIL: SpaceX earnings show Starlink margins deteriorating, OR the ETF breaks below \$115 on volume — that's the technical breakdown level

HEDGING: Easiest hedge is size — don't put more in than you can watch drop 20% overnight. If you want to get fancy, buy SPCX and sell covered calls into any Aug 4 rally to collect premium

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Buy

\$107.22 ▲ 8.00%

12M Price Target
\$125.00

52-Week Range
\$63.52 – \$153.86

Market Cap
\$96.55B

HOOD: Schwab's Blowout Retail Numbers Lift The Whole Group

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock ripped +8% today, and the tell is Schwab's earnings this morning — Schwab crushed estimates and specifically called out retail investors "piling into the market." That's a direct read-through for HOOD because they're the purest retail-trading play out there. If Schwab's boring customers are active, HOOD's degens customers are on fire.
- Bernstein put out a note saying HOOD's prediction markets business could eventually be bigger than their crypto business — that's a big claim, and combined with an analyst price target hike yesterday, sentiment flipped hard after a rough 4-day slide from \$115 to \$99.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what today really means: HOOD had been sold off 14% in a week on no real news — just profit-taking after a huge run. Schwab's print is the excuse to re-buy, because it confirms the underlying engine (retail volumes) is still running hot heading into HOOD's own earnings (typically early August). The Bernstein prediction-market call matters because it reframes HOOD from "crypto casino" into "the exchange for everything you can bet on" — sports, elections, econ data — which is a much bigger TAM and one the CFTC has effectively blessed under the current administration. Watch for a sympathy bid to continue if Interactive Brokers also beats this week.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one is the CLARITY Act and GENIUS Act — crypto market structure and stablecoin bills that Trump signed/advanced this year. These legitimize crypto trading rails, which is roughly 35-40% of HOOD's transaction revenue. Separately, the CFTC under Trump has been openly permissive on prediction/event contracts (Kalshi-style sports and election betting), and HOOD is aggressively expanding here — a hostile CFTC chair would kill this vertical, but that's not the current setup. Net-net: the regulatory environment for HOOD is the friendliest it's ever been, which is a huge part of why the stock is up ~70% YTD.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$107, HOOD trades around 22x forward revenue and roughly 58x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$58 for every \$1 of profit they're expected to make next year. That's expensive vs. Schwab (~18x earnings) and IBKR (~28x), but HOOD is growing revenue 40-50% while those guys grow ~10-15%. The multiple is only justified if crypto volumes stay elevated and prediction markets actually scale — if either wobbles, this thing can compress fast.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

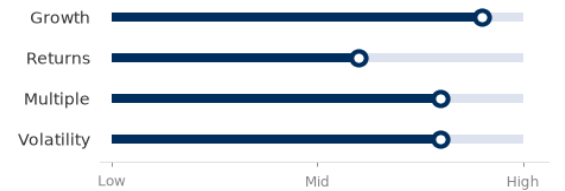
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-07-21 14:40 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$107.22
12M Price Target	\$125.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.6%
Market Cap	\$96.55B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,250M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.55
Fwd P/E	57.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$120.00	\$110.00	\$95.00
6 Months	\$140.00	\$118.00	\$85.00
1 Year	\$165.00	\$125.00	\$75.00
2 Years	\$220.00	\$160.00	\$65.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$220.00	\$55.00
10 Years	\$600.00	\$320.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Retail brokers and crypto-adjacent names — Schwab's beat confirms retail engagement is at multi-year highs, and the Trump admin's crypto-friendly stance keeps the tailwind blowing. Tech broadly +1.76% today as risk-on returns.

COOLING OFF: Defensive sectors and rate-sensitive names — money is leaving safety trades. Energy is quietly strong (+2% on the week) on geopolitical premium, but that's a separate story.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating back into high-beta retail/fintech after a 5-day pullback — this is a classic "buy the dip on good news" setup, not a new leg up. If IBKR beats this week, expect another push.

RELATED PLAY: If HOOD's prediction-market thesis plays out, watch CME (they own event-contract infrastructure) and Coinbase (COIN) as the second-order beneficiaries of a friendlier CFTC.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- SCHW (Charles Schwab): Beat earnings on retail flow surge — the read-through that lit HOOD's fuse today
- COIN (Coinbase): Direct crypto-regulation beneficiary, moves in sympathy with HOOD on any CLARITY Act news

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is the highest-beta name in this group — it leads on the way up AND on the way down. Today's +8% vs. Schwab's more modest move tells you HOOD is still the market's preferred retail-trading expression, but that also means it'll get hit hardest on any risk-off day.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the setup into earnings and the policy backdrop, but I can't pound the table at \$107 after a 70% YTD run.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% — this is a high-volatility name, so you want it big enough to matter but small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't ruin your month.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd rather add on pullbacks to \$95-100 than chase here. If you're not in, wait for a red day — HOOD gives you 5-8% dips regularly.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months, with the near-term catalyst being Q2 earnings in early August and prediction-market user disclosures.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Q2 transaction revenue misses badly, if the CFTC changes its tune on event contracts, or if BTC breaks down through key support — any of those and I'm trimming hard.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is just to size it smaller. If you want to get fancy, pair it with a small position in a boring, cash-generative financial (SCHW or even a bank) so you're not fully exposed to retail-mania cooling.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy

\$647.27 ▲ 0.22%

12M Price Target
\$750.00

52-Week Range
\$520.26 – \$796.25

Market Cap
\$1.64T

META: Bulls Circling Ahead of July 29 Earnings Catalyst

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat today (\$647, +0.22%) but it's been a rough week — down ~5% from Tuesday's \$681. The tech sector is up 1.76% today, so META is LAGGING its group, which tells me the weakness is Meta-specific, not macro. Likely investors trimming into the July 29 earnings print.
- Two narratives colliding in the news: (1) Motley Fool teasing a Zuckerberg announcement on July 29 that could "send the stock soaring," and (2) a reminder that Reality Labs (the VR/AR division) lost \$19.2B last year. That tension IS the Meta trade right now.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is happening: the market is de-risking ahead of earnings next week, and the OpenAI ad-revenue miss story (they're on pace to miss their ad forecast by 90%) is actually BULLISH for Meta longer-term — it means the AI-native ad disruption threat is way overhyped, and Meta's ad moat is intact. The July 29 print is the whole ballgame — if Zuck announces something concrete on Meta AI monetization or Llama enterprise licensing, this stock re-rates higher fast. The COO selling ~\$1M in shares is nothing to worry about (routine 10b5-1 plan), but the options market is screaming bullish with a 0.43 put/call ratio — meaning traders are buying 2.3 calls for every put, which is a real conviction bet on upside into the print.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang is the EU Digital Markets Act enforcement and the ongoing FTC antitrust case trying to force Meta to divest Instagram and WhatsApp — that trial is grinding through appeals and remains the single biggest long-term risk. On the friendlier side, the Trump administration has been notably softer on Big Tech antitrust than Biden's FTC, and the pending federal AI framework legislation would actually HELP Meta by preempting the patchwork of state AI laws (like California's SB-1047 successor) that are more onerous. Also watch the Section 230 reform chatter in Congress — any serious move to strip liability protection for algorithmic content would directly hit Meta's business model.

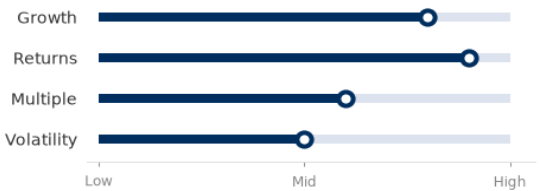
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~23x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$23 for every \$1 of profit Meta will make next year — this is actually CHEAP for a company growing revenue mid-teens with 35%+ operating margins. Compare that to Microsoft at ~32x and Google at ~22x — Meta is trading like Google but growing faster and buying back more stock. The reason it's not more expensive? The \$19B/year Reality Labs black hole and the perception that Zuck could pivot spending priorities on a whim.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$647.27
12M Price Target	\$750.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.9%
Market Cap	\$1.64T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$225M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	23.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$720.00	\$670.00	\$610.00
6 Months	\$800.00	\$720.00	\$580.00
1 Year	\$850.00	\$750.00	\$550.00
2 Years	\$1000.00	\$820.00	\$500.00
5 Years	\$1400.00	\$1000.00	\$450.00
10 Years	\$2200.00	\$1500.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech broadly (+1.76% today) as OpenAI's ad-revenue miss reassures investors that incumbents (Google, Meta) aren't losing share to AI natives as fast as feared. Energy also running on oil price strength.

COOLING OFF: Tech is actually down 2.63% over 5 days — there's been a rotation OUT of mega-cap tech into more defensive names as earnings season creates uncertainty.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is being cautious pre-earnings — waiting to see if the Mag 7 can justify their multiples. Meta reports July 29, and that print will set the tone for the whole group.

RELATED PLAY: If Meta's AI ad-targeting story hits, the second-order winner is Applovin (APP) and The Trade Desk (TTD) — the ad-tech ecosystem gets validated. On the infrastructure side, if capex guidance goes up again, Nvidia and the data center REITs (like Equinix) keep eating.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GOOGL (Alphabet): Holding up better than Meta this week — market sees search as more insulated from AI disruption after recent Gemini traction.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the picks-and-shovels winner every time a hyperscaler raises capex — and Meta's capex is going up.

META CONTEXT: Meta is lagging its mega-cap peers this week, trading at 46% of its 52-week range while others are closer to highs. That's actually a SETUP — the stock is coiled going into the most important catalyst of the quarter. Underperformance into a binary event often reverses hard if the print is clean.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the risk/reward into the July 29 print, but I'm not pounding the table because Zuck's capex discipline (or lack thereof) is a real wildcard.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — this is a core mega-cap holding, not a speculative bet, so size it accordingly.

ENTRY POINTS: Current \$647 is a reasonable entry given the pre-earnings pullback. If it dips to \$620 before July 29, back the truck up.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Near-term catalyst is July 29 earnings; medium-term is AI ad-monetization proof points showing up in revenue.

WHEN TO BAIL: If ad revenue growth drops below 10% YoY, or if Reality Labs losses accelerate past \$25B annually without any product traction, the thesis breaks.

HEDGING: If you're nervous into earnings, buy an August put option roughly 10% below current price — costs you maybe 2% but caps your downside if Zuck drops a capex bomb. Or just size the position smaller and sleep at night.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy

\$933.93 ▲ 7.91%

12M Price Target
\$1100.00

52-Week Range
\$103.38 – \$1255.00

Market Cap
\$1.05T

MU: Memory Rebound + CHIPS Act Tailwinds = Trillion Dollar Club

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU ripped +7.9% today on a big memory-sector rally — GM (that's the analyst kind, not General Motors — a Goldman/Morgan-type shop) put out bullish guidance on memory chip demand, and the whole complex moved: SanDisk +8%, WDC +9%, MU +7%. Translation: Wall Street is calling the bottom on the memory-price correction that whacked the stock from \$1,255 down to the \$850s.
- Volume was actually LIGHT today (14M vs 40-60M on down days) — that means the rally happened on short-covering and light buying, not conviction accumulation. Not a bearish tell, but worth noting the move is a bit fragile.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- China retaliation risk: if Beijing escalates its own chip restrictions or bans MU products (they've done it before in 2023), that's an instant 10-15% revenue hit
- Memory is boom-bust — when the cycle turns, it turns hard. A 20% ASP (average selling price) drop can flip them from massive profits to losses in two quarters
- The one nobody's watching: Samsung is aggressively trying to qualify their HBM4 with NVIDIA. If they succeed in 2026, MU loses pricing power fast — this is the sleeper risk that doesn't show up in the headlines

IN THE NEWS

Why GM's memory chip guidance could help stabilize stocks like Micron and Sandisk
Yahoo Finance · 2026-07-21 12:03

SanDisk Rises 8%, Western Digital Jumps 9%, Micron Adds 7% as Memory Rebound Accelerates
24/7 Wall St. · 2026-07-21 14:20

Stock Market Today: Nasdaq Higher As Memory Chip Names Rally; Schwab Wavers (Live Coverage...
Investor's Business Daily · 2026-07-21 14:17

Micron Technology, Sandisk, and Western Digital Are Down Big in the Past Month. Is Now the...
Motley Fool · 2026-07-21 13:20

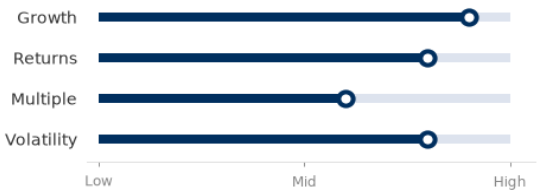
Why Micron Stock Is Jumping Ahead of Google Earnings
Barrons.com · 2026-07-21 13:05

WHAT OPTIONS TRADERS ARE DOING

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$933.93
12M Price Target	\$1100.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.8%
Market Cap	\$1.05T
FY2026E Revenue	\$52,000M
FY2027E Revenue	\$68,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.50
FY2027E EPS	\$22.00
Fwd P/E	64.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1050.00	\$970.00	\$850.00
6 Months	\$1250.00	\$1100.00	\$780.00
1 Year	\$1500.00	\$1200.00	\$700.00
2 Years	\$1800.00	\$1400.00	\$650.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1700.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$4000.00	\$2200.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semis/memory (+1.76% today) on the AI capex thesis reasserting itself; Energy (+1.98% 5D) on power demand from datacenters (yes, it's all connected — AI needs chips AND electricity).

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-0.88% 5D) and Industrials (-0.83% 5D) — the "real economy" is showing cracks while the AI economy runs hot.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from broad tech BACK into memory/hardware names specifically — this is a rotation within tech, not into tech. Software has been getting sold to fund the AI hardware trade.

RELATED PLAY: If MU keeps working, the picks-and-shovels play is ASML (litho equipment) and AMAT (deposition/etch) — they sell to Micron and everyone else, so they win regardless of who takes HBM share.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- WDC (Western Digital): +9% today — hard drive and NAND storage benefiting from same datacenter buildout thesis
- SNDK (SanDisk): +8% — pure NAND flash play, riding the memory rebound alongside MU

MU CONTEXT: MU is actually LAGGING WDC and SNDK on today's tape (+7% vs +8-9%), which is a bit odd since MU is the higher-quality name. That suggests today's move is more of a beta rally in the whole memory complex than a stock-specific breakout — meaning if the tape rolls over, MU will pull back with the group. I'd want to see MU lead, not lag, to get more aggressive.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the setup a lot, but a \$1 trillion market cap and light-volume rally into hyperscaler earnings means I'm not pounding the table at \$934.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — sized for the volatility, not the conviction. Memory stocks can drop 15% in a week for no good reason.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd rather add on pullbacks to \$850-880 than chase up here. If Google earnings disappoint next week, you'll get your shot.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the key catalyst being HBM4 volume ramps in 2H 2026 and CHIPS Act cash flowing into the P&L.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Samsung gets qualified at NVIDIA for HBM4, or if the next earnings call flags HBM pricing softness, I'm trimming hard. Also watch for China export control escalation.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy some 6-month put options roughly 10% below current price. Costs you a small insurance premium but caps your downside if the memory cycle rolls unexpectedly. Or just size it smaller and sleep better.

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$382.54 ▲ 3.51%	12M Price Target \$420.00	52-Week Range \$297.82 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.44T
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TSLA: Bounces Into Earnings, Robotaxi Story vs EV Reality

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA bounced 3.5% off yesterday's \$369 low heading into Q2 earnings (reporting after the bell tomorrow). The volume today is notably light (~11M vs 30M+ prior days) — this looks like a technical bounce and short covering, NOT real conviction buying. Options flow is screaming bullish (put/call of 0.47, huge unusual call activity at \$370-\$380 strikes expiring this week) — traders are positioning for an earnings pop.
- The "Terafab" chip fab story is getting attention — Musk floating a massive in-house semiconductor plant for Tesla + SpaceX AI chips. It's vaporware until we see capex commitments, but it plays into the "Tesla is really an AI company" narrative bulls need to justify a \$1.44T market cap.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the setup nobody's saying out loud: this is a coin-flip event tomorrow. Auto deliveries were soft in Q2, the \$7,500 federal EV tax credit was killed in the "One Big Beautiful Bill" earlier this month (takes effect Sept 30), and China price wars with BYD are crushing margins. BUT — the entire bull thesis has migrated away from cars to Robotaxi (Austin pilot expanding), Optimus robots, and energy storage. So tomorrow isn't really about the numbers — it's about whether Musk delivers a credible Robotaxi scaling timeline. If he does, the stock runs to \$420+. If he hedges or misses on auto margins badly, we retest \$340 fast because at 178x forward earnings, there's zero margin for disappointment.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

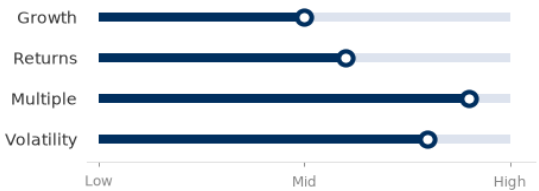
Two huge policy crosscurrents right now: (1) The federal EV tax credit expires September 30 under the reconciliation bill Trump signed — this is a direct headwind that will pull demand forward into Q3 (good short-term print, bad Q4/Q1). (2) BUT — the administration's push to loosen NHTSA autonomous vehicle rules is a massive tailwind for Robotaxi; federal preemption of state-by-state AV regulations would let Tesla scale nationally instead of fighting 50 different rulebooks. Also watch China tariffs — Tesla's Shanghai plant exports to Europe, and any escalation in the US-China trade spat could invite retaliation against Tesla specifically (Beijing has done this before).

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$382.54
12M Price Target	\$420.00
Upside / (Downside)	+9.8%
Market Cap	\$1.44T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$128M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.10
Fwd P/E	178.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$420.00	\$385.00	\$340.00
6 Months	\$475.00	\$400.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$550.00	\$420.00	\$280.00
2 Years	\$700.00	\$480.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$1000.00	\$600.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$1800.00	\$850.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+1.76% today) is leading on AI capex enthusiasm and easing rate expectations. Energy (+1.98% over 5 days) is running on Middle East oil price pressure. Both indirectly help TSLA — tech via the AI narrative halo, energy via making gas cars less attractive.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-0.88% over 5 days) is weak, which is technically TSLA's sector — signals that big-ticket consumer purchases (cars, appliances) are facing demand pressure heading into the tax credit expiration.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from broad consumer discretionary into AI-adjacent tech — TSLA benefits from this ONLY if it convinces the market it's an AI stock, not a car stock. Tomorrow's call is the audition.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the Robotaxi story, the picks-and-shovels play is NVDA (Tesla's Dojo chips still supplement with Nvidia) and lidar/sensor names. If you're skeptical, BYD (BYDDY) is winning the actual car war at 8x earnings vs Tesla's 178x.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): AI infrastructure demand still insatiable — every hyperscaler capex guide up has been a tailwind, and Tesla's own AI ambitions require Nvidia GPUs.
- BYDDY (BYD): Actually growing EV volumes double-digits while Tesla shrinks — winning on price in China, Europe, and emerging markets.

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is lagging both the AI leaders (NVDA, etc.) AND the EV leaders (BYD) — it's in an awkward middle where it's not delivering on either narrative right now. That's exactly why tomorrow's earnings call matters more than the numbers: Musk has to pick a lane and convince investors he can dominate it.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$340-360 on post-earnings weakness

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Auto gross margins drop below 15% or Robotaxi rollout stalls in 2H26

Hedging: Long BYD or pair with short on legacy autos (F/GM) exposed to same EV credit rollback

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy

\$205.09 ▲ 0.89%

12M Price Target
\$240.00

52-Week Range
\$164.07 – \$236.54

Market Cap
\$4.97T

NVDA: Chips Bounce Back as Export Rules Soften

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA bouncing +0.89% today after a rough week (down from \$212 to \$203 earlier) — the whole chip complex is reviving, with AMD, Micron, and SK Hynix all climbing yesterday. This looks like a relief rally after semis got hit hard on the OpenAI ad revenue miss story that's rattling the "AI trade" narrative.
- Volume today is notably light (25M vs 100M+ recently) — that tells me this is a technical bounce, not fresh conviction buying. The real test comes when volume returns.

WHY IT MATTERS

The OpenAI ad revenue miss (90% below their own forecast) is the elephant in the room — it's the first real crack in the "AI will monetize everything" story that's been propping up NVDA's multiple. Here's what it MEANS: if AI application-layer companies can't turn compute into revenue, hyperscalers (Microsoft, Google, Meta, Amazon) will eventually slow their GPU orders — and those four customers are roughly 40% of NVDA's revenue. That said, options flow is interesting — heavy call buying at \$207.50 alongside heavy put buying at \$205 suggests traders are positioning for a big move either way around earnings. The setup: NVDA needs to show data center growth is still ripping to reset the narrative that the AI monetization problem is a customer problem, not a chipmaker problem.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one right now is the ongoing US-China chip export framework — the Trump administration walked back some of the strictest Biden-era restrictions earlier this year, allowing NVDA to resume H20 chip sales to China (worth roughly \$15-20B annually). Watch for any escalation in trade rhetoric this week; any reversal here directly hits NVDA's China revenue line. Also on deck: the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions in Congress around expanding domestic AI infrastructure grants — if it advances, it's a tailwind for NVDA's US data center customers, who use those grants to buy more GPUs.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

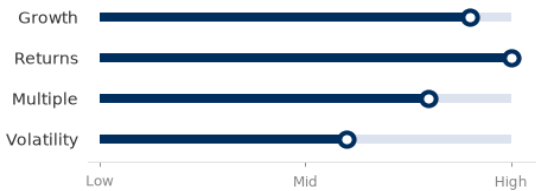
At ~35x forward earnings on a \$4.97T market cap, investors are paying \$35 for every \$1 of profit NVDA is expected to earn next year — expensive on absolute terms, but actually reasonable given they're growing earnings 40%+ annually. The PEG ratio (price vs. growth rate) is under 1, which is historically cheap for a company this dominant. The bigger question isn't "is it expensive" — it's "can they sustain 40% growth for another 2 years?" If yes, the stock is a bargain. If growth slows to 20%, the multiple compresses fast.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$205.09
12M Price Target	\$240.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.0%
Market Cap	\$4.97T
FY2027E Revenue	\$235M
FY2028E Revenue	\$295M
FY2027E EPS	\$5.85
FY2028E EPS	\$7.40
Fwd P/E	35.1x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$225.00	\$212.00	\$195.00
6 Months	\$260.00	\$235.00	\$180.00
1 Year	\$290.00	\$240.00	\$170.00
2 Years	\$340.00	\$275.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$350.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$500.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech broadly (+1.76% today) is reviving after last week's selloff, with semis leading the bounce. Energy (+1.98% over 5 days) is quietly the strongest sector — likely tied to AI data center power demand narrative gaining traction in DC.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary and Materials both weak over 5 days — classic late-cycle behavior when investors worry about consumer spending.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating BACK into AI/semis after a brief scare, but the light volume tells me institutions are still on the sidelines waiting for earnings clarity. This is a traders' bounce, not a conviction move.

RELATED PLAY: If NVDA runs, the power infrastructure names (Vistra, Constellation, GE Vernova) are the second-derivative play — every GPU NVDA sells needs 3-5x more power capacity than it did five years ago.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AMD (Advanced Micro Devices): Winning as the "credible #2" narrative gains steam — their MI400 chips are landing at hyperscalers who want to diversify away from NVDA dependency.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom silicon partnerships with Google and Meta are printing money — they're the picks-and-shovels play on hyperscaler custom chip designs.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is roughly in line with the semi group today but lagging AMD and Broadcom over the past month — that's worth watching. When the dominant player lags the challengers, it usually means market share concerns are quietly building. Not panic-level yet, but a signal.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Still the best-positioned company in the most important tech shift in a generation, but the risk/reward has narrowed as the stock has run.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't wreck your year.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$195-205 (where we are now is fine); I'd hold off chasing above \$220 until earnings.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is next earnings (early August) and Q3 guidance. That's the moment truth on whether the AI capex cycle is still accelerating.

WHEN TO BAIL: If data center revenue growth drops below 20% YoY OR if two hyperscalers cut capex guidance in the same quarter, I'm trimming hard.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — own less of it than you're tempted to. If you want real protection, buy protective puts on the semi ETF (SOXX) — cheaper than NVDA puts and covers you against a sector-wide selloff.

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$348.88 ▼ 0.88%	12M Price Target \$400.00	52-Week Range \$187.46 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.26T
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GOOGL: Cooling Off Before Earnings, But Setup Looks Strong

WHAT HAPPENED

- GOOGL slipped 0.88% on unusually light volume (4.8M vs 25-40M normal) — that's not real selling, that's just a quiet Monday drift lower into earnings week. The stock is down about 6% from last Tuesday's \$370, which looks like pre-earnings de-risking (investors trimming positions before results in case of a miss).
- Big signal from the news: OpenAI is on pace to miss its ad revenue forecast by 90%. That's massive for GOOGL — it means the "ChatGPT is killing Google Search ads" narrative that's been weighing on the stock is way overblown.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what the OpenAI ad-revenue miss really means: the bear case on GOOGL for two years has been "AI chatbots will eat Google's search ad business." If OpenAI — the best-funded, most-hyped competitor — can't monetize ads at even 10% of what they promised, that moat around Google's \$250B ad business is way wider than the market has priced in. The put/call ratio at 1.19 (more puts than calls, meaning traders are hedging downside) plus the unusual \$372.50 puts tells me the market is nervous going into earnings — which sets up an asymmetric bet: if earnings are just okay, the stock rips because expectations are low. The insider selling is noise (that's GV, Google's venture arm, doing routine distributions of portfolio company shares — not Sundar dumping stock).

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang is the DOJ antitrust remedy phase — the judge already ruled Google is a monopoly in search, and we're waiting on the actual penalty (could be forced Chrome divestiture, could be behavioral remedies only). Word from DC is the current administration has softened the aggressive breakup posture from the prior DOJ, likely favoring behavioral fixes over structural ones — that's a quiet tailwind nobody's pricing in. Also watch: the EU's AI Act compliance deadlines are hitting competitors harder than Google (Google's been prepping for years), and any China tariff escalation could actually help GOOGL relative to hardware-heavy peers since their business is mostly digital services.

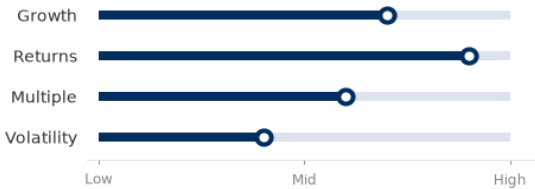
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$349, GOOGL trades around 35x forward earnings — meaning investors pay \$35 for every \$1 the company will earn next year. That's a premium to the S&P (~22x) but a discount to Microsoft (~38x) and Nvidia (~45x), which is bizarre given Google has the best AI research org on the planet, Waymo dominating robotaxis, and YouTube printing money. The market is pricing in permanent AI-search disruption that isn't materializing — that's your edge.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$348.88
12M Price Target	\$400.00
Upside / (Downside)	+14.7%
Market Cap	\$4.26T
FY2026E Revenue	\$405M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	35.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$385.00	\$360.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$420.00	\$385.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$460.00	\$400.00	\$300.00
2 Years	\$550.00	\$460.00	\$290.00
5 Years	\$800.00	\$600.00	\$320.00
10 Years	\$1400.00	\$900.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech overall up 1.76% today but down 2.63% on the week — this is a classic pre-earnings shakeout. Energy quietly up 2% on the week as oil rises, and Healthcare showing steady bid.

COOLING OFF: Chip stocks lost momentum today per the headlines — that's a warning sign for the "AI trade" broadly, but GOOGL is more insulated because it makes its own TPU chips and doesn't need to buy Nvidia hardware to grow.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is starting to rotate out of pure-play AI hype names (chips) into AI monetization names (platforms with actual revenue) — that's a direct tailwind for GOOGL, MSFT, META.

RELATED PLAY: If you want the second derivative, look at the data center power/cooling suppliers (VRT, ETN) — Google's \$75B capex has to land somewhere, and the picks-and-shovels crowd captures it.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- META (Meta Platforms): Riding the same "OpenAI can't monetize ads" tailwind, plus Reels ad revenue accelerating
- MSFT (Microsoft): Azure AI revenue converting from pilots to production — the enterprise AI story is real even if consumer AI is stumbling

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is lagging the mega-cap group a bit into earnings, which is actually your opportunity. It's the cheapest of the Big Tech AI names by forward P/E, has the best pure AI research (DeepMind), and the market keeps pricing in a search apocalypse that isn't happening. Laggard now, leader after earnings is the setup.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — the OpenAI ad miss is a genuine narrative-changer and the market hasn't caught up yet. Not 10/10 only because of DOJ overhang.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — this is a core holding, not a trade. Big enough to matter, not so big that DOJ headline risk wrecks you.

ENTRY POINTS: \$340-350 is a fine starting zone. If you get a macro-fear day and it dips to \$325, back up the truck. Don't chase above \$370 pre-earnings.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Near-term catalyst is earnings in the next 2 weeks. Medium-term catalyst is DOJ remedy ruling and Waymo scaling.

WHEN TO BAIL: If cloud growth drops under 25% YoY, or if the DOJ forces a structural breakup (Chrome/Android spinoff), or if capex keeps rising without revenue following by mid-2027.

HEDGING: Simple version — buy some cheap put options that pay off if the stock drops (like insurance on your house). Or just size the position smaller so you can sleep. The \$372 puts trading heavy tell you the pros are already doing this.

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy

\$206.42 ▲ 5.89%

12M Price Target
\$245.00

52-Week Range
\$61.44 – \$329.88

Market Cap
\$185.27B

MRVL: AI Chip Rally Resumes, CHIPS Act Tailwinds Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL popped 5.9% today to \$206 — this is a full recovery of last week's 9% dump. The rally isn't MRVL-specific; the entire semiconductor complex is bouncing back (AMD, Micron, SK Hynix, Intel all up 3-6%). Translation: this is a sector rotation trade, not a company-specific catalyst. Money is flowing back into AI/chip names after a mid-July risk-off moment.
- Volume today was thin (7.6M vs. the usual 25-30M) — a red flag. Big up moves on light volume often mean short-covering rather than real conviction buying. Watch if the next 2-3 sessions can hold above \$200 on normal volume.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what today's move really tells us: the market is treating MRVL as a high-beta proxy for AI capex sentiment — meaning when hyperscalers (Amazon, Microsoft, Google) are believed to be spending, MRVL rips; when doubts creep in, it sells off harder than peers. The stock is at 54% of its 52-week range with a \$185B market cap, which means investors have already priced in a lot of the custom-silicon-for-AWS story. The unusual call buying at \$292.50 strike expiring this month is aggressive — someone's betting on a near-term catalyst (likely an earnings pre-announcement or contract win), but that's a lottery ticket bet, not a fundamental signal. The bigger picture: as long as the CHIPS Act funding continues flowing and the Trump administration keeps pushing semiconductor reshoring, MRVL sits in a policy sweet spot.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

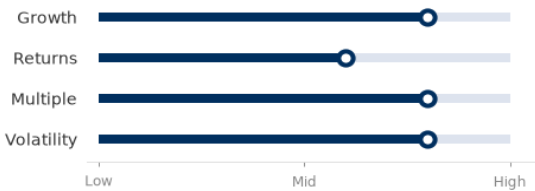
Two things to watch right now: (1) The CHIPS Act Phase 2 funding debate — there's ongoing negotiation about whether to expand the original \$52B allocation, and MRVL, while primarily fabless (meaning they design chips but don't build them), benefits indirectly because their manufacturing partners TSMC and GlobalFoundries are U.S. grant recipients. (2) China export controls — the Commerce Department is reportedly considering tighter restrictions on advanced networking chips, which is a double-edged sword: it hurts MRVL's China revenue (~15% of sales) but protects their domestic pricing power. Also worth tracking: any executive order on federal AI infrastructure spending could unlock direct government contracts for Marvell's data center silicon.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$206.42
12M Price Target	\$245.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.7%
Market Cap	\$185.27B
FY2026E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.85
FY2027E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	72.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$225.00	\$212.00	\$188.00
6 Months	\$260.00	\$230.00	\$175.00
1 Year	\$300.00	\$245.00	\$160.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$285.00	\$140.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$340.00	\$120.00
10 Years	\$750.00	\$450.00	\$100.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors broadly (+1.76% today) — AI chip demand narrative is reasserting itself after last week's wobble. Energy (+1.98% over 5 days) is quietly outperforming, benefiting from data center power demand — a second-order AI play.

COOLING OFF: Technology as a whole is still -2.63% on the week despite today's bounce — meaning breadth is narrow. Software names haven't participated in this chip rally, suggesting investors are picky about AI exposure.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from software back into semis and infrastructure. This favors MRVL specifically because it sits at the intersection of AI compute and networking — the "picks and shovels" of the buildout.

RELATED PLAY: If MRVL's rally is real, watch data center power/cooling names (VRT, ETN) and optical component makers (COHR, LITE) — they benefit from the same capex wave with less crowded positioning.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- INTC (Intel): +6% on RBC's Q2 beat call — the turnaround narrative is getting fresh legs, and foundry customers may be shifting business as CHIPS Act incentives kick in.
- AMD (Advanced Micro Devices): +4% — MI300 AI accelerator momentum and continued share gains in data center CPUs.
- AVGO (Broadcom): +3% — the direct MRVL competitor in custom silicon; when AVGO rallies, MRVL usually follows because they're seen as the two ASIC winners.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL is actually leading its peer group today (+5.9% vs. the pack at 3-4%), which suggests it was the most oversold coming into the session. That's a mean-reversion bounce, not necessarily leadership — watch if MRVL can outperform on the NEXT up day too. If yes, real strength. If no, this was just short covering.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$185-195 on chip sector pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Loss of Amazon/Microsoft custom silicon contract, or AI capex cycle rolls over

Hedging: Pair with a short on a pricier AI name like AVGO, or buy protective puts 15% below current price

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	GTLB GitLab Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.2/10	BUY	
Price: \$33.39 · 1M: +29.3% · P/S: 5.6x · Cap: \$5.6B		OPT:NEUT	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
2	DDOG Datadog, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	7.9/10	BUY	
Price: \$260.70 · 1M: +17.8% · P/S: 25.3x · Cap: \$92.8B		OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$145 entry				
3	MSFT Microsoft Corporation AI & Machine Learning	7.7/10	BUY	
Price: \$400.37 · 1M: +9.0% · P/S: 9.3x · Cap: \$2974.1B		OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
4	AVAV AeroVironment, Inc. Defense Technology	7.5/10	BUY	
Price: \$147.64 · 1M: -2.4% · P/S: 3.8x · Cap: \$7.5B		OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
5	LHX L3Harris Technologies, Inc. Defense Technology	7.5/10	BUY	
Price: \$280.25 · 1M: -1.9% · P/S: 4.1x · Cap: \$52.2B		OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$245 entry				